

TO OVERCLOCK OR NOT TO OVERCLOCK

All you need to know about overclocking

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When your PC starts struggling to keep up with your applications and games, the first solution that crosses your mind would be to upgrade your components. However, this solution usually tends to be an expensive one since a significant boost in performance can only be obtained by upgrading one or both of your primary components including the CPU and graphics card. What do you do when you want a slight performance boost to ensure that you can continue using the same hardware for a few more months or even an entire year? Or maybe you want better performance from your existing hardware than what it offers? Your answer is overclocking. Quite a common practice in the enthusiast PC building community, overclocking can either be your best friend or your worst enemy. In the following stories, we will try to ensure that overclocking becomes your best friend and continues to be one.

BASICS

Before we move forward, you must know what overclocking your hardware actually does. Whether it's your CPU, graphics card or RAM, they run at particular clock speeds. Overclocking them means boosting the clock speeds in order to churn out

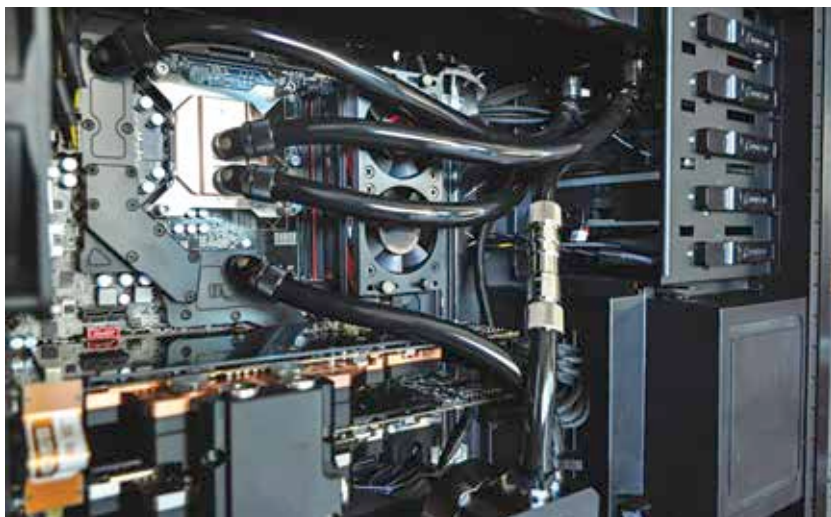
better performance from your components. Manufacturers will always ship the components at a fixed stock clock speed. And when you overclock those components, you try to hit a higher clock speed while trying to maintain stability. In simpler terms, your components will run faster than what the manufacturer had intended them to. You need to check if overclocking your component will void your warranty or not. Overclocking can potentially damage your components.

Although overclocking can be done with just the push of a button or with a slider in an application, it doesn't guarantee that it's going to function as expected. You could have your own reasons for overclocking your components.

If you're looking for better overall system performance or if you're trying to get a higher frame rate from your graphics card. There are several advantages to overclocking your hardware and we'll be exploring them in the next section.

BENEFITS

The most obvious advantage of overclocking your components would be faster speeds. If you overclock your CPU, you will notice an increase in performance with better responsive and faster load speeds. Some of the areas where you will observe a substantial boost in performance is in rendering and editing videos. If you still feel that your system's true potential is being held back, maybe you need to upgrade your hard drive to a faster storage solution, such as an SSD.



An overclocked PC will give you an incredible performance boost